Ben Seegatz

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Research Interests

Machine learning for biomedicine, graph neural networks (GNNs), adversarial machine learning and machine unlearning, explainability for AI, AI ethics and responsible deployment, credibility assessment and disinformation detection, fraud detection, science communication on the capabilities and limits of AI.

Education

Master of Science in Data Science — *University of Vienna*
Master's degree program — *October 2024 – Present*
Master's thesis (in progress): "A Lightweight Membership Inference Attack on Approximate Graph Unlearning" | Supervisor: Yllka Velaj
Current GPA: 1.56 | Focus areas: Machine Learning, AI Ethics, Graph Unlearning, Data Visualization
Electives: Explainability for LLMs, Signal & Image Processing, AI as an Archival Science

Bachelor of Science in Business Informatics — *WU Vienna University of Economics and Business*
Bachelor's degree program — *October 2020 – September 2024*
Bachelor's thesis: "How can Social Bots influence Political Opinions during Elections?" | Final GPA: 1.9
Semester abroad: University of Richmond, Virginia, USA (Fall 2022); coursework in Data Science and Decision Sciences

Bachelor of Arts in Social and Economic Communication — *University of the Arts Berlin*
Bachelor's degree program — *October 2017 – September 2020*
Bachelor's thesis: "The End of History – An Investigation of the Narrative of the End" | Final GPA: 1.7
Focus areas: Strategic Communication, Media Theory, Philosophy, Communication Design

Teaching Experience

University of Vienna — *September 2026 – Present*
Tutor, Deep Learning for Natural Language Processing — *Vienna, Austria*

- Tutoring students in the course Deep Learning for NLP

University of Vienna — *February 2026 – August 2026*
Tutor, Human Computer Interaction — *Vienna, Austria*

- Taught the fundamentals of React Native development to a cohort of 200 students
- Graded assignments, provided structured written feedback, and answered questions via the course forum

University of Richmond — *August 2022 – December 2022*
German Teaching Assistant — *Richmond, Virginia, USA*

- Taught a weekly mid-level (B1/B2) German class of 8 students under Prof. Caroline Weist; developed lesson plans and teaching materials

Professional Experience

Erste Digital GmbH — *October 2026 – Present*
Data Engineering Intern — *Vienna, Austria*

- Data engineering with Databricks, Tableau and WebFOCUS

Looping Group / Looping One *October 2019 – September 2026*
Associate Data Scientist & Editorial Associate *Vienna, Austria / Berlin, Germany*

- Data analysis, visualization and exploratory research for client reports (social media performance, sentiment and audience analysis) in Python, R and Tableau
- Worked with API interfaces and implemented algorithms for network and user analysis
- Designed and delivered internal workshops on LLM data privacy, SEO and data literacy (approx. 50 participants each); moderated company meetings with 200+ participants
- Real-time monitoring and crisis communication for the BMW Situation Room at the IAA 2021 and IAA 2023 in Munich

University of Music & Performing Arts Vienna *September 2021 – November 2021*
Assistant Director & Stage Manager *Vienna, Austria*

- "Das Schweigen" by Nathalie Sarraute, graduation production directed by Dávid Paška

Goethe-Institut Berlin *November 2018 – January 2019*
Intern *Berlin, Germany*

- Organization and implementation of the event program for course participants

Selected Projects

Sound Visualization	MSc Data Analysis Project (2025/26): real-time transformation of audio into frequency-reactive visualizations (bass, mid, treble)
EMIK 2022	Interdisciplinary art-tech performance: trained a StyleGAN (Python, PyTorch) on exhibiting artists' works to generate visual elements for a live music performance
Rebranding Alexanderplatz	BA project: concept for a public exhibition on the historical narratives of Berlin's Alexanderplatz

Technical Skills

Programming	Python, R, SQL, JavaScript, React / React Native, HTML, Bash
ML / AI	PyTorch, TensorFlow, scikit-learn, Hugging Face; NLP, network analysis, generative models
Data Engineering & BI	Databricks, Tableau, WebFOCUS, Power BI, Microsoft Azure
Analysis & Documentation	Microsoft Excel, Google Analytics, Talkwalker, LaTeX, Markdown

Languages

German	Native speaker
English	C2 (certified; C2 courses at Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, grade 1.3)
French	B1
Russian	A2
Chinese	A1.1 (certified, WU Vienna Language Center)

Extracurricular Activities

Piano Performance & Accompaniment *2006 – Present*
Pianist & Korrepetitor *Various Locations*
Concerts at venues including Berlin Philharmonie, Mercedes-Benz-Arena and Martin's Château Du Lac Brussels. Awards include multiple 1st prizes at Jugend musiziert, 2nd prize at the Steinway Piano Competition and a special prize for pianists at the Bundesgesangswettbewerb 2023